

Social impact assessment research is part of ABARES' applied social research and analysis. Reports have been prepared for the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry, other government agencies, research and development corporations, and industry bodies.

Publication date: 10 June 2005

This guide covers methods for assessing the social well-being of people involved in fishing activities in Australia, their contributions to the broader community, and the values and attitudes associated with fishing.

Information on the changing social well-being of fishing dependent communities is essential to inform decision making, and for strategic planning both regionally and nationally.

The Australian fishing sector is at the forefront of recognising and analysing the social implications of changing conditions in the fishing sector.

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Document	Pages	File size
Social Assessment Handbook: A guide to methods and approaches for assessing the social sustainability of fisheries in Australia PDF 	56	1.8 MB

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Publication date: 26 September 2012

The paper summarises the key findings of ABARES work to assess the potential impact of proposed Commonwealth marine reserves networks on commercial and charter fishing. The assessments were commissioned by the Department of Sustainability, Environment, Water, Population and Communities.

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Document	Pages	File size
Commonwealth marine reserves network proposal: ABARES social and economic assessment – Science and Economics Insights paper PDF 	8	449 KB

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Understanding the value of fishing activities and fish resources is fundamental to fisheries management and policy development. This study identified the social values and quantified the economic value of recreational game fishing.

It involved surveys of game fishers, local businesses and community members at three eastern Australian sites (Mooloolaba, Port Stephens and Bermagui) between December 2010 and May 2011.

Game fishers completed over 400 survey questionnaires; and businesses and community members completed over 150 questionnaires.

Survey results, combined with information on charter boat activities, releases of tagged game fish, game-fishing tournaments, fishing clubs and profiles of regional centres, provide insights into the value of game fishing to regional communities.

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Document	Pages	File size
A socioeconomic evaluation of three eastern Australian game-fishing regions PDF 	224	18.4 MB

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Publication date: 4 November 2005

This report provides results of a study examining the social well-being of people working in commercial fishing in the East Gippsland region and their impacts on the East Gippsland region.

A diverse range of fishers operate in both the inland and ocean waters in and around East Gippsland, and catch is landed in the region from many fisheries.

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Document	Pages	File size
Social assessment of commercial fishing in the East Gippsland region: Report of a case study conducted as part of the Social Assessment Handbook PDF 	69	584 KB

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Publication date: 21 July 2005

This report provides an assessment of the potential social and economic impacts of the proposed Cod Grounds Marine Protected Area (MPA).

The Cod Grounds is located in Commonwealth waters, approximately four nautical miles off the coast of Laurieton, New South Wales.

This assessment examined potential social and economic impacts of the proposed Cod Grounds MPA on commercial fishers and their families, and on fish co-operatives whose members currently land catch from the Cod Grounds.

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		File size
Socioeconomic impact assessment of the proposed Cod Grounds Marine Protected Area PDF 	67	983 KB

If you have difficulty accessing these files, please visit [web accessibility](#).

Publication date: 01 June 2005

This report provides results of a study examining the social well-being of people working in the South Australian Marine Scalefish Fishery (MSF) and their impacts on the South Australian community.

The MSF is a large and diverse fishery stretching across most of South Australia's coastline.

Several hundred fishers work in the MSF, contributing significantly to the communities and economies of many coastal regions.

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Document	Pages	File size
Social impacts of the SA Marine Scalefish Fishery: case study project PDF 	145	1.3 MB

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